

o means the only content creators at GitLab. If you would like to collaborate with us on a content project, read more below!

We organize our work into two key focus areas: Content Strategy and Content Operations (Ops). Think about the projects in your current role: some tasks you can complete quickly, or are a regular, expected part of your day-to-day. But other tasks might require detailed planning, longer timelines, multiple stakeholders, and further collaboration. That's the difference between Content Strategy and Content Ops.

Content Strategy

Content Strategy projects include bespoke or high impact/high visibility content work, requiring planning, multiple stakeholders, and often VP-level or above engagement.

Examples: Creating a net-new landing page, content for newly established campaign pillars, GTM content, DevSecOps Survey, customer change comms

Content Ops

Content Ops includes content that's either part of already-established programs like current campaigns, customer stories, or optimization of existing content or "velocity content", content asks that can be accomplished quickly, with little input or few to no stakeholder reviews. It also includes content benchmarking, measurement, and reporting.

Velocity Requests

Examples: Quick-turn requests with minimal effort and few to no additional reviewers updated wording on a landing page, email copy, small tweaks or repackaging of existing content

If you have an immediate request that requires review by multiple stakeholders, follow the VP-level request workflow.

Always-on Programs

Ongoing/existing campaign content, customer stories, solutions page refreshes

Page content updates and optimization, benchmarking, measurement

The GitLab Blog

The Content Strategy & Ops team is also responsible for the GitLab Blog. Check out the blog handbook to learn more.

Requesting support

Whether you have a Content Strategy or Content Ops request, work begins with a conversation as the default. Collaboration ensures your projects have the best outcome and largest positive impact on GitLab's goals.

If you know your request falls into either Content Strategy or Content Ops, open a new request

in the Content Strategy project or the Content Ops project and fill out the corresponding template.

Not sure which bucket your request falls into? Open a general request in Content Ops and we'll advise.

The team will then review all incoming requests in the Content Strategy & Ops project and will schedule accordingly based on the request type, current workload, and priorities.

NOTE: If you have an immediate Content Strategy request that needs to be escalated and requires multiple stakeholder reviews, please add a VP-approved label to your request, and tag the VP-level stakeholder.

Need help finding relevant content to use in an email or to send to a customer? Ask for help in the content channel.

Sample content creation process: Campaign ebook or whitepaper

Task	
DRI	

Define general campaign theme and target audience/segment for asset in collaboration with Product Marketing, campaign leads, and Global Content	Campaign manager
Provide input on search keywords and topic/angle	
Search marketer	
Write first draft	
Writer (Content Strategy & Ops)	
Complete peer review (looking at flow, clarity, consistency, story)	
Editor (Content Strategy & Ops)	
Complete campaign review (checking for alignment with campaign objectives)	
Campaign manager	
Complete SME review (looking at messaging and positioning)	
Product marketing manager	
Proofread/prepare for Design (cleaning up and resolving edits)	
Writer (Content Strategy & Ops)	
Put content into layout	
Brand designer	
Design review (checking for typos, errors, broken/incorrect links, the look of the design, proof infographics, double check that index links lead to the right pages)	Writer (Content Strategy & Ops)
Implement final edits	
Brand designer	
Final proofread (checking that all edits are implemented, confirming links)	
Writer (Content Strategy & Ops)	
Publish	
Campaigns team	

Content types: Definitions and workflows

Blog post

A post on the GitLab blog can educate, entertain, tell a story, take an opinionated stance, etc. A blog post is dated, so it only reflects thoughts, ideas, and processes from a specific period of time. For communicating long-term/evergreen ideas or processes, consider using a topic page or SEO page instead. A blog also can and should be repurposed as a web article/cluster page

Visit the [blog handbook](#) to learn more about the blog publishing process.

Whitepaper

A whitepaper is a technical and focused topic study intended to educate a prospective buyer during the Consideration or Purchase stages of a campaign. The whitepaper offers a problem and solution instance in a granular, technical tone. The content team member should collaborate closely with their product marketing counterpart when researching and writing the asset so that the content reaches appropriate technical standards for the intended audience.

Any technical GitLab team member is welcome to write a whitepaper and collaborate with the content team. If you're interested in writing a whitepaper, open an issue in the Content Strategy project and describe your idea, or post in the content Slack channel. Whitepapers should be related to specific use cases and support campaigns, when possible.

Examples:

1. A seismic shift in application security
2. How to deploy on AWS from GitLab

Ebook

An ebook tends to be broader in scope than a whitepaper and provides a clear definition of the topic, along with various industry standard best practices. Ebooks typically provide awareness-level content, but can dive deeper into GitLab if it's intended for late-stage consumption. Ebooks should be related to specific use cases and support campaigns, when possible.

Content Writer/Strategist workflow: A Content Strategy & Ops team member develops ebook content with input and review from their product marketing counterpart. More technical or instructive ebooks may require more collaboration with product marketing. Ebooks follow the internal gated content asset workflow.

For other GitLab team members: To request an ebook from the content team, feel free to open a Content Strategy issue.

Examples:

1. Guide to a DevOps platform migration

2. How to drive business success with DevSecOps

One pager

An infographic is an illustrated overview of a topic or process, and is typically an ungated asset. Infographics should tell a story using data, diagrams, and text. It can be used to discuss industry trends, relate insights, or explain different stages of a project. Open a Content Ops issue to get started.

Example:

1. DevSecOps platform 1-pager
2. Forrester TEI infographic

Topic page

A topic page is a high-level explanatory "pillar" page dedicated to a specific topic, such as version control, DevSecOps, or continuous integration. Topic pages should explain what the subject is, why it is important, and explain the basic concepts of the subject. Topic pages should include links to additional related resources, such as blogs, web articles, videos, and case studies, as well as at least one CTA to a gated asset. Other SEO pages also include educational, informational content, designed to support topic pages using keywords and search terms. They are similar to blogs in length, but differ in that they are not dated and the content is evergreen (see more about blog posts).

Examples:

1. What is CI/CD?
2. What is developer-first security?

Case study

Case studies are in-depth customer stories that provide insight as to how GitLab has resolved significant software workflow problems for a company. The case study tells the story using quotes from customer interviews and straightforward metrics that broadly show the impact of adopting GitLab.

Case studies are created in partnership with the customer reference team. The customer reference team has a process in place for how they add new references and provide a list of customer value drivers. Customer case studies are typically written by the Content Strategy & Ops team, but the case study development process is managed by the Customer Advocacy team. If you have an idea for a new case study, please contact the Customer Advocacy team.

Examples:

1. CARFAX improves security, cuts pipeline management and costs with GitLab
2. Lockheed Martin saves time, money, and tech muscle with GitLab

3. Online travel giant Agoda boosts developer productivity with GitLab

SECTION: marketing/brand-and-product-marketing/content/content-marketing.md

The Global Content team is responsible for showcasing GitLab's expertise and leadership in DevOps through easy-to-find content that is educational, thought-provoking, and market-defining. As part of Global Content, the Content Marketing team works with stakeholders across GitLab to provide readers with end-to-end content experiences that garner trust, create source credibility, and generate customer engagement.

Meet the Content Marketing team

Chandler Gibbons

- Title: Manager, Content Marketing
- GitLab handle: @chandlergibb
- Slack handle: @Chandler Gibbons

Sharon Gaudin

- Title: Sr. Content Marketing Manager
- Area of focus: DevOps platform
- GitLab handle: @sgaudin
- Slack handle: @Sharon Gaudin

Kristina Weis

- Title: Sr. Content Marketing Manager
- Area of focus: Automated software delivery
- GitLab handle: @KristinaWeis
- Slack handle: @Kristina Weis

Working with Content Marketing

What we can help with

We're here to help with your content, writing, and editing needs! Ask us for help with:

- Writing content for GTM campaigns (mostly awareness- and consideration-level eBooks, landing pages, nurture emails, related blog posts and/or articles)
- Writing blog posts to support strategic Editorial team needs
- Writing topic pages and subtopic pages
- Writing and reviewing customer case studies, in collaboration with the Customer Reference team
- Reviewing content for web pages, emails, or other marketing assets
- Reviewing customer-facing emails and other communications

How to request help from Content Marketing

The team will review all incoming requests in the Content Marketing project and will schedule accordingly based on current workload and priorities.

Requesting content creation for campaigns

- For assets that will have multiple associated tasks or steps, such as a campaign eBook, create an epic for the asset itself and then create issues within the epic that correspond to each step that needs to be completed by a separate owner. Content creation should be one of those issues.
- Create the content creation issue in the Content Marketing project. Be sure to label the issue with the Content Marketing label and assign the Content Marketing team member who is working on the campaign.
- The Content Marketing team will use the content creation issue to manage the content creation process end to end, from drafting the content through peer review, technical review, and final proofreading.

Requesting content creation for other projects

- Create an issue in the Content Marketing project using the most relevant issue template. Please include as much background information about the request as possible, including the deadline for the final deliverable, how it will be used and promoted, goals, and target audience. Feel free to link to other relevant issues and epics, and/or attach the request to an existing epic, if appropriate.

Requesting content editing and review

- Create an issue in the Content Marketing project using the most relevant issue template. Please include as much background information about the request as possible, including a deadline for review. Feel free to link to other relevant issues and epics, and/or attach the request to an existing epic, if appropriate.

Typical content creation process: Campaign ebook or whitepaper

Task	DRI
Define general campaign theme and target audience/segment for asset in collaboration with Product Marketing, campaign leads, and Global Content	Campaign manager
Provide input on search keywords and topic/angle	Search marketer
Write first draft	Writer (Content Marketing)
Complete peer review (looking at flow, clarity, consistency, story)	Editor (Content Marketing)
Complete campaign review (checking for alignment with campaign objectives)	Campaign manager
Complete SME review (looking at messaging and positioning)	Product marketing manager
Copy edit	Editor (Content Marketing)
Proofread/prepare for Design (cleaning up and resolving edits)	Writer (Content Marketing)
Put content into layout	Brand designer
Stakeholder review (checking for typos, errors, broken/incorrect links, the look of the design, proof infographics, double check that index links lead to the right pages)	Writer (Content Marketing), Editor (Content Marketing), Product marketing manager

Implement final edits	Brand designer
Final proofread (checking that all edits are implemented, confirming links)	Writer (Content Marketing), Editor (Content Marketing)
Publish	Campaigns team

Note: Each role should be assigned at the project outset; for example "Editor (Content Marketing)" would be a single person who would be identified in the relevant project issues/epics and would review the draft at all of the designated times to keep things consistent.

Current projects (Q3 FY23)

Campaigns and lightning strikes

- Capability Campaign: DevOps Platform
- Solution Campaign: Automated Software Delivery
- Solution Campaign: Security & Compliance

Content types: Definitions and workflows

Content is most effective when it has the right message, to the right audience, at the right time, in the right medium. That's why the content marketing team produces a variety of content types designed to reach different people at different stages of the buyer journey.

At GitLab, everyone can contribute. While the content marketing team produces a large amount of content, they are by no means the only content creators at GitLab. If you would like to contribute content such as blog posts, eBooks, whitepapers, etc, read more about these content types and how to submit them.

Blog post

A post on the GitLab blog is used during the Awareness or Consideration stage of the buyer's journey. A blog post can educate, entertain, tell a story, take an opinionated stance, etc. A blog post is dated, so it only reflects thoughts, ideas, and processes from a specific period of time. For communicating long-term/evergreen ideas or processes, consider using a topic page or web article instead.

Visit the blog handbook to learn more about the blog publishing process.

Blog repurpose

A blog can and should be repurposed as a web article/cluster page if the content is evergreen and Awareness stage. The blog should also be older than six months and not GitLab-centric.

Blog repurpose workflow

1. Work with the SEO team to identify existing, older blogs that are the best options for repurposing.
1. Ensure that the editorial team is aware of the intention and has approved the redirect.
1. In a Google doc, copy and paste the existing blog. From there, use the keyword spreadsheets

to identify the best possible updates -- this can include changing the title to a better keyword phrase, identifying areas of copyediting improvements, adding links, adding a 'More On' section, and elaborating on longtail keywords throughout the content.

1. Create a merge request on the www.gitlab.com project.

1. Once the web article is edited and merged, open an issue to redirect the blog URL to the new web article. Add the new URL and old URL in the issue. The labels are included in the issue, do not assign.

1. After the web article is merged and the blog redirected, add the web article link to the associated Topics page in the sidebar.

Whitepaper

A whitepaper is a technical and focused topic study intended to educate a prospective buyer during the Consideration or Purchase stages of a campaign. The whitepaper offers a problem and solution instance in a granular, technical tone. The content team member should collaborate closely with their product marketing counterpart when researching and writing the asset so that the content reaches appropriate technical standards for the intended audience.

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Examples:

1. A seismic shift in application security

1. How to deploy on AWS from GitLab

eBook

An eBook tends to be broader in scope than a whitepaper and provides a clear definition of the topic, along with various industry standard best practices. eBooks typically provide awareness-level content, but can dive deeper into GitLab if it's intended for late-stage consumption. eBooks should be related to specific use cases and support campaigns, when possible.

Content Marketer workflow: A Content Marketing team member develops eBook content with input and review from their product marketing counterpart. More technical or instructive eBooks may require more collaboration with product marketing. eBooks follow the internal gated content asset workflow.

Follow the instructions for creating an internal gated asset and start the eBook process by creating an epic using the epic template.

For other GitLab team members: To request an eBook from the content team, feel free to open a content request issue. If you would like to write an eBook, we have an eBook google doc template available for GitLab team members to use with general best practices.

Examples:

1. An intermediate guide to GitOps, Kubernetes, and GitLab

1. The GitLab Remote Playbook
1. The benefits of single application CI/CD

Infographic

An infographic is an illustrated overview of a topic or process, and is typically an ungated asset. Infographics should tell a story using data, diagrams, and text. It can be used to discuss industry trends, relate insights, or explain different stages of a project. Open a design request issue when planning an infographic to figure out a structure for the graphic, and ask the design DRI for recommended copy lengths.

Example:

1. Git cheat sheet
1. How GitLab accelerates workload deployments on AWS

Topic page

A topic page is a high-level explanatory "pillar" page dedicated to a specific topic, such as version control, DevSecOps, or continuous integration. Topic pages should explain what the subject is, why it is important, and explain the basic concepts of the subject. Topic pages should include links to additional related resources, such as blogs, web articles, videos, and case studies, as well as at least one CTA to a gated asset.

Web article

Web articles are educational, informational content, designed to support topic pages using keywords and search terms. They are similar to blogs in length, but differ in that they are not dated and the content is evergreen (see more about blog posts). Web articles should be linked on one or more topic pages, and should serve as a deep-dive into a specific sub-topic. Web articles are created in accordance with SEO research and campaign goals that are listed in the topics clusters spreadsheets. Complete the SEO web article template when creating a new piece of content.

Examples:

1. How to choose the right continuous integration tool
1. What are Git version control best practices?
1. What is developer-first security?

Case study

Case studies are in-depth customer stories that provide insight as to how GitLab has resolved significant software workflow problems for a company. The case study tells the story using quotes from customer interviews and straightforward metrics that broadly show the impact of adopting GitLab.

Case studies are created in partnership with the customer reference team. The customer reference team has a process in place for how they add new references and provide a list of customer value drivers. The content team is responsible for writing the case study asset using

this template, publishing the case study to the website, adding the customer logo to the customer logo grid, and ensuring that the case study goes through proper social media and newsletter steps.

Examples:

1. How Hotjar deploys 50% faster with GitLab
1. Security provider KnowBe4 keeps code in-house and speeds up deployment

Recommended Slack channels

Anyone at GitLab can reach out to the content team in the content channel on Slack.

Here are a few other Slack channels to check out if you'd like to learn more about marketing content:

- content-team-lounge: Where the content team can hang out. This is a public channel.
- content: A general discussion channel for all things content, including blog posts, case studies, videos, webcasts, newsletter content, interesting articles, etc
- content-updates: A rolling log of new, published content. Once an article, blog post, case study, webinar, video, landing page, etc. is public, add it to this channel with a TL;DR description of the content.
- marketing: The main channel for the entire marketing group.

SECTION: marketing/brand-and-product-marketing/content/editorial-team.md

Related pages

- Blog handbook
- Brand guidelines

Why use the blog style guide?

The blog style guide covers styling, punctuation, spelling, and terminology guidelines for posts on the GitLab blog. If you have questions about writing, word usage, etc. that aren't included in the style guide, feel free to reach out to the Editorial team (@sgittlen) or open a merge request with your suggested update and ping the team there.

A few best practices for effective writing

The blog editor may point out some of these common areas for growth in the comments section of the blog post. Here are a few things to keep in mind:

- Don't start a sentence with "This" or "That": It requires the reader go to the previous sentence to find out what you're referencing. Instead, define what you're saying outright.
- Don't assume your reader knows what you're talking about. Define key concepts and terms, and explain what particular products and businesses do.
- Add links to relevant documentation, issues, MRs, or past blog posts whenever possible. This

allows the reader to click the link and learn more if they're interested.

- If the blog editor needs to read your sentence more than once, they may ask questions about what you're trying to say, or ask you to explain it. The editing process is conversation and collaborative, and may require a few asynchronous exchanges to help us get to a common understanding. The goal is always to help improve the clarity of ideas and language in the blog post, which will help us drive results!

When in doubt, go through the draft again but this time adopting the eyes of a reader instead of a storyteller. Also, it is always easier to edit something that someone else has written, it is much harder to edit your own copy. This is where peer reviewers and the editorial team comes in!

Contextualize your post

It's also important to consider the context of the post. Ask yourself why it matters to the reader, and, if possible, connect your story to a broader industry issue. Don't jump in straight away with what you want to tell the reader about without first giving some thought to and communicating why the reader should be interested. That type of context can "uplevel" your content and result in a better reader experience.

There are generally two ways to go about this:

1. Include a "sweep" paragraph near the beginning of your post to contextualize

The following prompts may help you determine what to write about here:

- What is the status quo?
- What problem are you trying to solve or what challenge are you hoping to address?
- What will the reader gain from reading your post? What will they learn?

You can see an example of "sweep" paragraphs at the beginning of this post on low-code/no-code tools, giving history and context to the topic before diving into the GitLab-specific story.

2. Uplevel the whole post

Example: "The trouble with technical interviews? They aren't like the job you're interviewing for" was originally planned to be just about how GitLab's Frontend group redesigned its technical interviews. After discussion, it was decided that there was a broader story to tell here, because the GitLab story (redesigning Frontend technical interviews) was really addressing a greater, industry-wide problem, which is that technical interviews aren't effective and aren't always inclusive.

Not every post will be suitable for this treatment, so you and the Editorial team member reviewing your post can use your discretion. In some cases it may be appropriate to tweak just the title of the post to make it broader (e.g. "How ~~GitLab~~ CI helps solve common DevSecOps challenges").

Acronyms

When using acronyms or initialisms,

ensure that your first mention uses the full term and includes the shortened version in parentheses directly afterwards. From then on you may use the acronym or initialism instead.

> Example: A Contributor License Agreement (CLA) is the industry standard for open source contributions to other projects.

Below are some common acronyms and initialisms we use which don't need to be defined first (but use sparingly, see Tone of Voice):

- AFAIK - as far as I know
- ICYMI - in case you missed it (for social only)
- IIRC - if I recall correctly
- IRL - in real life
- TL;DR - too long; didn't read

American English vs. British English

We use American English by default. Please consult this list of spelling differences.

Ampersands

Use ampersands only where they are part of a company's name or the title of a publication or similar. Example: Barnes & Noble

Do not use as a substitute for "and."

Branch names

When writing the name of the branch, the best practice is to style it in back-ticks as opposed to quotation marks, italics etc. Example: `sk-branch-name`

Capitalization

See below for styling of specific words.

Case

Use sentence case for all titles and headings.

Feature names

All GitLab feature names must be capitalized. If referring to a GitLab feature as part of a workflow rather than speaking about the feature itself, use lower case.

> Examples: "GitLab Issue Boards are a powerful project management and collaboration tool." vs "The editorial team uses an issue board to track the progress of blog posts."

Job titles

We do not capitalize job titles, regardless of whether they appear before or after a person's name.

GitLab functions/departments/teams

These are elements that make up GitLab the company's organizational structure. Capitalize the name of the element, but not the word after:

> Example: Engineering function, Security department

Brand and publication names

Ensure you style brand names consistently with how the company does.

> Example: WiFi Tribe, DigitalOcean

The only exception to this is for brand names that are in all upper or lower case. Always capitalize the first letter, regardless of how it is styled in a company's logo.

> Examples: Reddit, Lego

If the word "the" forms part of a brand or publication's name, capitalize it:

> Examples: The Wall Street Journal, The Times

You can drop the "The" entirely if used as follows:

> "We spoke to a Wall Street Journal reporter"

Contractions

We favor contractions ("can't," "didn't," "it's," "we're") to sound more human and less formal.

Dates

Months

Spell out, unless using the full date (see below).

Specific dates

Jan. 3, 2019 (abbreviate month, no rd after 3)

Headlines

Please see headline advice in the blog handbook.

Lists

Use `or` - to create a bulleted list in Markdown. No period is necessary at the end of each bullet point.

Numbers

Numbers with four or more digits should include a comma.

> Examples: 2,000; 100,000

In body copy

Spell out one to nine. Use numerals for 10 upwards. Try to avoid beginning a sentence with a number, but if unavoidable, spell it out.

In headings/subheadings

Use numerals. If at the beginning of a heading, capitalize the first word following.

> Example: 3 Strategies for implementing a microservices architecture

Pronouns

Unless referring to someone in particular, use gender-neutral pronouns ("they", "them").

Punctuation

Only one space after a period is necessary.

Include one space after ellipses (...)

See below for when to hyphenate specific words.

We use en dashes (·) rather than em dashes (·). Include a space before and after the dash.

Use % instead of "percent" at all times.

Quotes

Quotation marks

Use double quotation marks for direct quotes, and single quotation marks for a quote within a quote. Single quotation marks may also be used for specialist terms or sayings.

- Include periods and commas inside ending quotation marks.
- Leave semi-colons, colons, and dashes outside of the quotation marks.
- Include other punctuation based on the sentence meaning.

Examples:

- > Recently, an article was published stating, "Software is eating the world."
- >
- > What do you think of the claim, "Software is eating the world"?
- >
- > "Do you agree that software is eating the world?" wrote the author.

Tense

When including direct quotations from interviewees in blog posts, we prefer to use the feature journalism style of present tense for verbs such as "said," "explained" etc.

- > Example: "Ruby was optimized for the developer, not for running it in production," says Sid.

The exception to that would be when quoting from an event that was obviously in the past; in that case please use the past tense so the reader is not confused or misled.

Referring to interviewees

For blog posts, prefer referring to interviewees by their first names as this is less formal and more in keeping with our tone of voice.

Voice

We prefer that writers use active voice instead of passive voice in blog posts. Voice describes whether the subject of a sentence receives or performs the action of a verb. Learn more about tone of voice in this blog post by Grammarly.

- > Example: "The GitLab community submitted 1 million merge requests in March 2019." (active)
vs. "One million merge requests were submitted by the GitLab community in March 2019."
(passive)

Word choice

When in doubt, use the "future" styling of a word. So, "internet" is not capitalized, "startup" is not hyphenated, etc.

Word list

How to spell and style commonly used words.

- Agile
 - A is capitalized when referring to Agile methodology
- AI-powered DevSecOps platform
 - AI-powered is always hyphenated
 - powered and platform are always lowercase in written content (there may be exceptions when the term is used in design and brand assets)
 - If GitLab precedes the term, Platform is capitalized but powered is not: GitLab AI-powered DevSecOps Platform
- all remote
 - We refer to GitLab as an all-remote company (not remote friendly, remote first, or remote

only)

- hyphenated only when appearing before a noun ("GitLab is an all-remote organization"/"GitLab is all remote")
- Board
 - when in reference to the GitLab Board or Directors or our Board members, Board is capitalized
 - a board in general does not need to be capitalized
- built-in/built in
 - always hyphenated when appearing before a noun e.g. "GitLab has built-in CI/CD." Two words when used as a verb e.g. "GitLab comes with CI/CD built in."
- cloud native
 - not capitalized, and no hyphen, regardless of how it is used
- co-founder
 - hyphenated, not capitalized
- continuous delivery, deployment, integration
 - not capitalized
- developer
 - use the abbreviation "dev" sparingly; do not capitalize
- DevOps
 - D and O always capitalized
- E-Group
 - references to E-Group should always include a capital E, hyphen, and a capital G
- emoji
 - use emoji for singular and plural
- Git
 - always capitalized
- GitHub
- GitLab
 - G and L are always capitalized, even in GitLab.com
- GitLab Self-Managed
 - Not self-managed GitLab, GitLab self-managed, or GitLab Self-managed
- internet
 - not capitalized
- Kubernetes
 - always capitalized, never abbreviated to K8s (except on social)
- lifecycle
 - always one word
- Master
 - we no longer use this term to refer to branches...please use main instead
- multicloud
 - one word, no hyphen, lowercase m, lowercase c
- open source
 - no hyphen, regardless of how it is used
- operations
 - use "ops" sparingly; do not capitalize
- plugin
 - always one word
- set up/setup
 - two words for the verb, one for the noun ("How to set up a Kubernetes cluster"/"Let's walk through the Kubernetes cluster setup process")

- sign up/signup
 - two words for the verb, one for the noun ("Sign up for a GitLab.com account"/"Upon signup, you will be sent a confirmation email")
- startup
 - no hyphen
- web
 - not capitalized

Editorial review checklist

Diversity, Inclusion, and Belonging

We have a checklist for writers in the blog handbook to help guide a more inclusive writing process. The checklist below is for editors to ensure that our published content reflects our values of Diversity, Inclusion, and Belonging (DIB).

Are the images inclusive?

- Are images (cover image and any screengrabs) inclusive?
- Is the alternative text descriptive (for SEO and accessibility)? If not, tag the author or make the change yourself. Here are some tips on writing descriptive alternative text.

Is the writing inclusive?

- Does the post use inclusive language?
- Confirm that people featured in the post are referencing using their correct pronouns? You can do a quick check on the individual's team page profile and Slack profile.
- Whenever possible, edit to remove extra words to keep sentences short and concise. For example: "The family is excited to buy their very own house" can be edited to read "The family is excited to buy a house". These edits make the post easier for all readers to follow.
- Check that the writing is appropriate for a global audience. Flag any regional metaphors or United States-centric language.
- Ensure that all links are meaningful and descriptive (e.g. avoid link text such as "read here" or "this article"). Descriptive links are more useful and accessible for people using screen readers.

Ask the DIB team

- If you have a DIB question about the blog post, don't just guess. Reach out to the DIB team or tag the leads of the appropriate team member resource group (TMRG) in the blog issue or merge request.

Style and language

- Does the post adhere to our style guide?
- Is it written in American English?
- Are all titles and headlines in sentence case?

SECTION: marketing/brand-and-product-marketing/product-and-solution-marketing/_index.md

<link rel="stylesheet" type="text/css" href="/stylesheets/biztech.css" />

<i class="fas fa-bullhorn"></i> Welcome to the GitLab Product and Solution Marketing Handbook

We create positioning and messaging to fuel demand and adoption of GitLab's solutions and products. We develop market and competitive intelligence in order to develop actionable insights on market trends, customer needs, and competitive insights that guide go-to-market and product strategy. We identify, recruit, and activate customer advocates to demonstrate momentum and trust in the market.

What does Product and Solution Marketing do?

Our mission is to accelerate GitLab's path to market by developing insights, positioning, and messaging that communicate the value of our platform and solutions.

- We are core to GitLab's go-to-market process, operating at the intersection of product management, sales, customer success, and marketing.
- We help deliver a connected customer experience with every touchpoint reinforcing the brand, values, solutions, and vision of GitLab.
- We create programs and messaging to demonstrate momentum and trust in the market.

There are 10 key capabilities of team members. Sub-teams and individuals typically 'major' in certain areas and 'minor' in others. It's rare that one person would be expert in all 10.

- Target Market and Audience Definition
- Positioning, Messaging, Strategic Narrative, and Content Development
- Launch Planning & Execution
- Pricing and Packaging
- External Evangelism
- Customer Advocacy
- Business Management
- Sales Enablement
- Competitive Marketing
- Analyst Relations

<i class="fas fa-star fa-fw color-orange font-awesome"></i>Go-to-market (GTM) Strategies

We develop and champion go-to-market strategies that take into account our sales goals, product strengths/limitations, and marketing vehicles. These strategies include recommendations on product and solution areas upon which to focus our marketing and sales efforts and provide supporting messaging, positioning, personas, key assets/content, demos, sales enablement, and more. We deliver our stories/messages to customers, analysts, press through collateral, events, customer meetings, etc., where we get first-hand feedback from the audience to iterate and improve our strategies. We champion the customer perspective for continuity of experience across the various customer touchpoints.

mermaid
graph LR;

id1 --> id3
id2 --> id3
id3 --> id4
id4 --> id5

```
subgraph "Product and Solution Marketing"
  id1[Market Research]
  id3[Go-to-market Assets]
end
subgraph "GitLab R&D"
  id2[Product]
end
subgraph "GitLab GTM"
  id4[Sales <br>Marketing]
end
subgraph "The Market"
  id5[Customers <br>Users <br>Community <br>Press <br>Analysts <br>Thought Leaders
<br>Competitors]
end
```

Each team within Product and Solution Marketing contributes uniquely and equally toward a comprehensive GTM strategy that includes:

- characteristics of accounts and personas to pursue with marketing and sales,
- routes to market (e.g. direct, channels),
- key messages,
- curated assets/content needed for the buyer's journey, (this team creates many key assets but assets may also come from SAs, evangelists, blogs, partners. This team curates compelling ones that pull the prospect along their journey.)
- key questions for sales to ask, competitive positioning, overcoming objections, other sales resources
- influencing the influencers (press and analysts), responding to analyst RFIs for magic quadrants (MQs) and waves.

Solutions GTM Page has links to all of this and more.

<i class="fas fa-star fa-fw color-orange font-awesome"></i>Subject matter expertise

Product marketers are core to GitLab's go-to-market process, operating at the intersection of product management, sales, customer success, and marketing. Some examples of initiatives led by product marketing team include:

- They lead go to market across different channels working with many cross functional teams within marketing. E.g., Solutions based Go to Market of Automated Software Delivery or Security and Governance
- They lead product launches collaborating with cross functional teams across product, campaigns, sales, and marketing. E.g., GitLab Dedicated, GitLab Duo for AI-powered DevSecOps
- They lead pricing and packaging communications with cross functional teams across product, sales, PR, marketing, etc. E.g., End of availability of Starter / Bronze or Premium price

increase

- They lead marketing launches E.g., GitLab 16 launch, Quarterly Launches
- They lead messaging and content for global events that GitLab participates or hosts E.g., GitLab Commit, DevSecOps World Tour, AWS / Gartner and other events GitLab participates in
- They lead messaging and content for sales enablement and accreditation E.g., DevSecOps messaging accreditation, AI messaging accreditation

Requesting Product and Solution Marketing help

All Product and Solution Marketing work is aligned to the overall Marketing OKRs. The specific team OKR/KRs are tracked and managed as issues in the Product and Solution Marketing Project. If you need additional support from the team, the simple process below will enable us to support you.

1. Open an PMM Support Request Issue. PLEASE fill in what you know.

1. Be sure to @mention a specific team member who you are requesting help from. If you don't @mention a team member, your request may not be processed. Ping @doneal or @gl-pmm if you don't know whom to tag.

1. If you need more immediate attention please send a message with a link to the issue you created in the product-marketing slack channel. You can ping the PMM team with @pmm-team.

Product Marketing Team

- @dsteer - VP of Brand and Product Marketing
- @mklaus - Sr. Director, Product Marketing
- @jhurwitz - Senior Manager, Product Marketing
- @anair - Product Marketing Manager
- @dhom - Product Marketing Manager
- @lalves - Principal Product Marketing Manager, AI
- @jkempton - Senior Product Marketing Manager, Competitive Intelligence
- @sladha - Principal Product Marketing Manager, Security
- @aholland - Senior Product Marketing Manager, Financial Services
- @lburrows - Senior Public Sector Product Marketing Manager
- @mdelaney - Senior Product Marketing Manager, Embedded Systems/Automotive/Aerospace

Marketing and Sales Enablement

Through research and iteration, Product and Solution Marketing becomes the subject matter experts around key product capabilities and/or solutions. We provide the voice of the customer to help to connect the dots across the marketing functions (web, campaigns, digital ads, ABM, events) and sales stages (SDR nurture, SAEs/SAs pursuit/close, CSM expansion) by providing an outside-in perspective of our buyer's journey experience, along with that of their key influencers, from pain to purchase and from interest to sales. We strive to optimize the journey to efficiently achieve return on marketing and sales investment.

Product and Solution Marketing team members serve as subject matter experts and conduct in-house and partner sales trainings scheduled by the Sales Training team and Partner Marketing. For info go to the Sales Enablement page.

Metrics

The Product and Solution Marketing organization is often considered the nexus that brings together research, customer and market insights. The Product and Solution Marketing organization collaborates and partners with other teams in marketing for certain execution elements, such as Digital Experience, Brand, and Integrated marketing. Additional key collaborators are sales for using the revenue plays for effective iteration, and Product Management to help with customer engagement via our CAB as well as providing input into analyst outreach.

The organization is an influencer on the indicators below. We cannot drive the results on our own, only through collaboration, but we use these indicators to assess the impact of our actions.

Leading indicators

- Position and progression in key Gartner Magic Quadrants and Forrester Waves
- SEO of most critical terms
- Content creation and use
- Leads generated and SAOs

Lagging indicators

- ARR for Enterprise and Commercial
- First order new logos (is the message capturing new prospects?)
- Uptiering (are we arming sales with compelling offers?)
- Customer retention (are expectations set by marketing messages aligned with product experience?)
- Consistent outcomes from sales value plays (is the recipe a good one?)

Collateral

All field and customer facing collateral generated by Product Marketing is hosted on

- HighSpot (for sales teams)
- Pathfactory (for campaigns)
- Solution Pages (for web users)

Acronyms

- PMM: Used to refer to Product Marketing Management (as a practice or the entire Core Product Marketing team) or specifically to a Product Marketing Manager. Examples:
 - Product Marketing Management: "Let's collaborate with PMM since they are customer and market SMEs"
 - Product Marketing Manager: "Parker is the PMM on my cross-functional team."
- TMM: Used to refer to Technical Marketing Management (as a practice or the entire Technical Marketing team) or specifically to a Technical Marketing Manager. This team is now Developer Advocates and reports into Developer Relations.
- PM: Product Management or Product Manager. Don't use PM to refer to Product Marketing, use PM exclusively for the Product team.

SECTION: marketing/brand-and-product-marketing/product-and-solution-marketing/asset_inventory.md

This page used to provide an inventory of assets created and maintained by the Product and Solution Marketing team. We have since updated the inventory so it includes all assets and it can now be found within Marketing Strategy & Performance

We have kept the following info specific to the Product and Solution Marketing team as it may assist them in determining how to enter into the Marketing inventory.

</div>

Which assets belong to Strategic · edge cases

Things Product and Solution Marketing doesn't own within GitLab, but contributes to

Product and Solution Marketing often makes significant contributions to assets that are owned by other GitLab teams. Examples include a product release post with a PMM messaging lead, or a Sales enablement resource that heavily relies on competitive research. This raises the question of whether certain assets "belong to" SM enough to be in our inventory. Our bias will be to include these assets.

If we can identify an "SM DRI" and we made significant contributions, we will inventory the asset. We will also take care to not misrepresent that we wholly created or own the asset.

Things GitLab doesn't own or manage, but contributes to

Product and Solution Marketing also contributes to assets that are owned or managed by others outside of GitLab, such as a recording of us speaking at a conference, or a piece we wrote in an industry publication. When those assets live somewhere GitLab does not manage, we will try to make a GitLab-owned and managed copy of the asset for internal use. Our bias will be to include assets like these in this inventory, even without our own copy of them.

Things we just review and approve

We are interested in reviewing, vetting, and then including assets in the SM inventory even when our contributions are minimal or null, other than having reviewed and approved. Our motivations are first, to serve those searching for "everything related to X" and second, for this inventory to serve as a repository of high quality assets. As subject matter experts, SM team members are already, sometimes asked to review and approve of content or other assets. We want to multiply that value by inventorying what we've reviewed.

We celebrate that GitLab enables any team member, and in many cases even community members, to contribute on the company web site, Unfiltered blog, handbook, Unfiltered YouTube channel, and so on. Those are great examples of GitLab values and culture in action, and it's indisputably generative. We also acknowledge, however that this can result in impedingly uneven asset quality, such as in tone, focus, or technical depth. As a result, it can be difficult for non-SMEs to know whether an asset they find is fit for reuse in contexts with higher quality requirements.

We do not, at this time have a process for ingesting, reviewing, or including assets like these. While we consider adding additional metadata and process, you might already find some in the inventory.

In due course

There have been several changes to the team recently, so this part may no longer be applicable but saving just in case

{{% panel header="Update the inventory" header-bg="info" %}}

New assets should be added to the inventory as part of our definition of done for SM Support Request Issues, i.e. as part of finishing the asset itself. We'll explore use of the template and whether we can provide useful links and e.g. require checking a particular box that in this issue, assets were either not created or were inventoried.

The team member who is the SM DRI for an asset · the primary creator, contributor, and/or decision maker from SM · is responsible for adding the asset to the inventory.

Creating assets is often a collaboration between Product and Solution Marketing and other GitLab team members or community members. By inventorying an asset here, we're not indicating it's "owned" by SM v. other parts of the department or company, only whether SM has contributed enough to identify a DRI for our team and in our view, to warrant having it here.

SM leadership will support team members in completion of the inventory, and they will support broader GitLab team members by serving as backup DRIs for their team's assets.

{{% /panel %}}

Lead a group conversation

The SM group conversation lead could share this page and the inventory with the call, showing assets recently created. This handbook-first approach can reduce slides in the deck and relieve some of our six-week scramble to list all the things.

Since GC decks list both assets and activities, we'll need to either still list activities separately or find another source, like tagging Calendar events and pulling those into a shared view...

Demonstrating the inventory briefly and regularly would also encourage self service, before asking if we have a thing, where it is, or for us to make it.

Ask for help or suggest a change

To make a change request, or if you have questions or need help please open an SM support request.

You're also welcome to ask in our strategicmarketing Slack channel, but remember it's ephemeral :)

We have a backlog of change requests for the database, dashboard, and project.

Learn@GitLab Inventory

Inventory Files

The inventory files provide a standardized way to capture, find, and reference created assets (inventory) which can be used by everyone. The data is kept in the yml files in the /data/inventory/ directory. There is one file per team to make ownership clear and make management easier.

Layout

The inventory folder lives under /data of the website and is organized in the following manner to enable scaling to multiple groups. The thought is that each group can be CODEOWNERS for their own team inventory, but it should still be easy to search through the inventory of "everything" to find what you are looking for.

```
<pre>
/data/inventory
|
---- learn.yml (Technical Marketing - will change to team name in another MR)
|
---- pmm.yml (Product Marketing)
|
---- ...
|
---- teamname.yml (Team Name)
</pre>
```

Format

The search through the inventory of "everything" to find what you are looking for it is important that all team files use the same format and data fields. This file represents the SSoT for what that format and fields are. If you are making changes make them here first, then make sure everything else follows.

Accepted field descriptions are (fields in bold are required):

```
<pre>
- title:                (the display name of the asset)
  author:                (the author of the asset)
  team:                  (the name of the team that created the asset)
  assettype:              (currently one entry only. Expect this to grow as teams
are added. asset type = video, demo)
  datepublished:          (month and year content first published. In iso-date
format. eg 2020-05)
  lastchanged:            (date the asset was last changed)
  gitlabrelease:          (major.minor GitLab release the asset is built about/on.
eg 12.10)
  usecase:                (use case the asset focuses on. Derived from customer use
case page. Acceptable values are: )
```


- vcc
- ci
- cd
- devsecops
- agile
- simplifydevops
- cloudnative
- gitops
- remote
- other

```

stage:                (multi-select list of stages the asset focuses on.
Values should match main entries in stages.yml)
category:             (multi-select list of categories the asset focuses on.
Values should match main entries in categories.yml)
link:                 (link to the ungated asset)
embeddedlink:         (link to embeddable version of asset - typically for
videos and demos)
gatedlink:            (link to the gated asset)
shortdescription:     (a short description of what the asset is about)
learn:                (values: true or false or blank. Does this asset show up
on learn@gitlab.com. tech marketing team to add this only please)
</pre>

```

Getting help

If you have questions or need help please open an SM support request.

SECTION: marketing/brand-and-product-marketing/product-and-solution-marketing/devops-metrics.md

The first step to improving DevOps and Agile processes is measuring them. Once we can measure a process, we can identify opportunities for greater efficiency and begin to correlate those opportunities with business value, connecting the entire organization with a common goal and vision. If you are just starting out on your Agile journey, or you're looking to connect your existing Agile processes with other groups and lines of business, following are four steps to help you get started.

Step 1: DORA Metrics

DevOps Research and Assessment (DORA) has created a list of four metrics that are straightforward, focused, and easy to implement. They form an excellent foundation for your metrics initiatives, helping improve your existing DevSecOps efficiency while also building a bridge to business stakeholders.

These four "DORA" metrics are:

- Deployment Frequency
- Lead Time

- Mean Time to Recover
- Change Failure Rate

DORA metrics are available in GitLab Group-level value stream analytics (VSA) and in the CI/CD analytics. APIs are also available for all four DORA metrics. To learn more check out the DORA API documentation

Here's an overview of each metric, with a look at how they matter to the company as a whole.

Deployment Frequency

How often you're deploying software to production. This is one of the most foundational DevOps/Agile metrics because if you aren't deploying regularly, you can't be delivering value.

It's worth noting that this doesn't tell you how valuable the software you're deploying actually is—we'll cover that in the next section—but without it, there's nothing to measure. You need to deploy to generate value. And, most likely, you already have a similar metric like this in play. This should be the easiest metric to find and report.

Mean Lead Time for changes (LEAD TIME)

This is the time from code commit to having that code live in production. For some companies, this is a matter of minutes. For others, it's months. There are schools of thought that will tell you that what you're really measuring here is cycle time, not lead time, but the important thing is that you measure this, whatever the name.

Lead time is a fantastic metric because it's a great gut-level indicator of what is possible. If you're managing the DevOps process in one form or another, you can view this as an overall health-check. If lead time is months, there are probably some areas of opportunity to streamline and automate systems and processes.

There are myriad reasons for long Lead Times. Like Deployment Frequency, Lead Time doesn't diagnose a problem, but it can show you where to look for answers.

This also benefits the business. Let's assume a business planner or product manager sees an opportunity to react to a shift in market demand. If they can get something in the hands of users by next Friday. In that situation, a lead time of 10 hours sounds promising. It indicates that if they can get everyone aligned quickly enough, having changes in production by the deadline could work.

A lead time of 60 days, on the other hand, would rule out the move, in most cases, unless there's something exceptionally easy about the required work. But even that failure to execute can start a fruitful cross-team discussion of why the lead time is so high, helping to place a value on addressing DevOps investments.

Mean Time To Recover (MTTR)

This is the amount of time it takes to bounce back from a failure. If you deploy something and it fails, how long will it take to make the failed service usable again?

At first glance, this metric might not seem particularly relevant to business, but it's essentially an indication of the business risk of making changes. This metric also illustrates one of the ways DevOps can really function as a business or revenue enabler. The better the MTTR number (the smaller your time to recover), the more comfortable the company is going to be with experimenting and innovating.

If DevOps is absolutely on top of this, able to snap back from failure in minutes, they can actually encourage the business to start taking more (acceptable) risks and begin feeling more comfortable with running experiments. Ultimately, that can generate more revenue and profit.

Change Failure Rate (CFR)

CFR looks at how frequently you encounter deployment failures that require remediation. How often do things break so badly that you need to roll them back and test out your MTTR to fix them?

Again, this doesn't diagnose an issue, and any specific deployment could have to be recalled for any reason. It may not have anything to do with the DevOps pipeline at all. It could be a purely external factor like a problem with content, or a market shift. But generally, when tracked over time, CFR tends to provide a helpful view into the health of your DevOps pipeline, and that can also drive business-led conversations.

If the number is high and remains high over time, let's assume a CFR of 40%—that's an awful lot of business value getting wasted and never making it to customers. In that case, if you can diagnose the source of the problem, it's very reasonable to spend resources improving that performance. It might make very good financial sense to spend 20% of each cycle paying down technical debt for 3 months if it's going to increase overall value delivered by 15% in the end.

If you're tracking CFR, you can start to make data-driven decisions about things like infrastructure, because it is now attached to a documented end-user value.

So, in summary, these four DORA metrics are a wonderful place to start, because:

- They enable you to understand Velocity and Speed AND also overall Quality and Stability.
- They're fairly easy for DevOps teams to generate on their own, using tools they have available today
- They provide useful guidance for what you're already doing
- They help the business understand how DevOps and business can work together with a shared concept of value

Step 2: Measure your Value Streams and Flow

There are a number of different frameworks for measuring the flow of value to users and the blockers that get in the way.

If you're familiar with Lean Six Sigma, you've probably heard quite a bit about Value Stream Mapping. You've also probably heard a lot about Flow, which is a framework for measuring those value streams.

There are four Flow metrics:

Flow Velocity

Throughput, or velocity over time.

Flow Time

The time it takes for an item to go from start to completion.

Both of these are very similar to traditional DevOps metrics, similar to those discussed above.

What's unique about Flow is the next two:

Flow Efficiency

Flow Efficiency identifies waste. It measures the ratio of active time vs. wait time out of the total Flow Time, so you can see whether you're losing value by waiting around.

Flow Load

The number of Flow Items currently in progress, whether active or waiting.

Flow Load is often measured as Work in Progress (WIP). On a gut level, we all know there's a cost to context switching and having too many irons in the fire, but tracking the number of in-progress items and correlating it to outcomes lets us quantify that cost and make data-driven decisions about how much work to take on.

Step 3: North star metrics

Every company and every initiative will have a different North Star metric that defines success. For a retail site, it might be annual customer spend. For a medical device manufacturer, it might be a target latency. For a video game company, it might be hours played.

Ideally, your company should help define this metric at the executive level, beginning with something like an OKR and cascading down.

How do I choose my North Star?

There's no one right metric. The important thing is to poll that metric as frequently as possible, find proxy metrics you can poll more frequently, and view everything we've discussed before this through that lens, and have everyone, from business to delivery, iterate together based on the results.

So as an example, let's say you're making tax software. Your North Star metric may be total revenue, or maybe revenue per user. The problem is, you won't know what that looks like until the end of tax season, which is months away. This is what people often call a lagging indicator, because it measures an end-state.

Meanwhile, you need to measure something, and you've observed that time spent on tax simulators

seems to correlate with increased revenue during tax season. This is a leading indicator, as it predicts behavior that follows. While it isn't a perfect match for your North Star metric, it's something you can measure now, so you can use the metric as a proxy, continue to look for other leading metrics to track, and compare your expected performance to actual performance when your lagging metrics become available.

Step 4: Correlation

Now that you can map what really matters, you can evaluate your DORA and Flow metrics in the context of business outcomes and start to discover where you can add the most value. For example:

- Does reducing Flow Load increase engagement with the simulator? Great! Maybe you should focus on fewer items.
- Does a rising Change failure rate negatively impact that metric? Maybe it's time to pay down that debt.

But again, while it's important to know what's important, that only becomes actionable when you have enough visibility into the process that you know what levers to pull. And that's why it's critical to give everyone on your team, from Planning to Dev to Ops to User Experience after you release, a common set of metrics and a common language. Because that's how a business embraces Agile.

SECTION: marketing/brand-and-product-marketing/product-and-solution-marketing/devops-tools.md

The DevOps tools below are commonly found in a build-your-own DevOps tool chain. Many of these can be replaced by GitLab's single platform for the entire DevOps lifecycle.

Project management

Issue Tracking

- Atlassian Jira
- Asana
- Microsoft TFS/VSTS/Asure DevOps
- Pivotal Tracker
- Bugzilla
- JetBrains
- Zoho Corporation
- Airbrake
- Axosoft
- Bugsnag
- Countersoft
- Inflectra Corporation
- Redmine
- BMC Remedy
- QA Symphony

- FogBugz

Issue Boards

- Atlassian Jira
- Asana
- Trello
- Basecamp
- Wrike
- Podio
- Zoho Projects
- Freedcamp
- Teamwork Projects
- TrackVia
- Dapulse

Portfolio Management

- Atlassian Jira Portfolio
- CA Technologies / Rally
- Wrike
- Plutora
- IBM Rational Team Concert
- HP Application Lifecycle Management

Service Desk

- Atlassian Jira Service Desk
- Zendesk
- Freshdesk
- CA Service Desk Manager

Source code management

- GitHub
- Atlassian Bitbucket
- Microsoft TFS/VSTS/Azure DevOps
- CA Technologies / Rally
- IBM Rational Clear case
- Perforce
- Helix VCS
- Assembla
- Beanstalk
- Rhodicode
- Mercurial
- Subversion aka SVN
- Kallithea

Code Review

- Atlassian Crucible
- Gerrit
- Smart Bear Collabo